

Encrypted Mess

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You are a master computer scientist with many, many PhDs under your belt: one in Cryptography and another in Agriculture, specifically grain and corn. As one following such a convoluted career, you are now experiencing what every other computer scientist of your generation has or will: you have forgotten your password to a particular corn website. You do not have it written down, and your trusty LastPass is compromised. However, it took genius to earn your PhD, and genius is what you consider yourself as you whip out your rusty, 30 year-old binder. Perfect, a collection of passwords.

But as you turn to the first page, you notice that all your passwords are encrypted. Your mega brain cannot quite comprehend why you would encrypt passwords in a notebook, but at this point, it does not matter. There is a key to decrypt all the passwords, and you have written the following as a hint:

A skii randomly crashes into a 3-fingered cat, augmenting the firsts of July or November.

Some “randos” constantly add to this scenario, and then try to square up the now put-together cat. At the end, the “randos” come together and complete their final sum.

59031465795670403454624024723797186972890584965764779450842496928546765557891914-

42668377334728535939

Certainly, this collection of words must mean something cryptic yet revealing. The only remaining information you have is the length of your password, which is 21 characters, and you know your password is composed of a series of words separated by a delimiter and no numbers. You care about security, after all.

By any means necessary, deduce your password. You really need access to that corn website.

The solution is on page 9.